

ASUS ROG CROSSHAIR IV FORMULA

# TRUE AIM

**Those in search of a performance motherboard for the fresh-off-the-fab AMD 890FX chipset have a new icon to look up to - the ASUS Republic of Gamers (ROG) Crosshair IV Formula.**

And a very apt name is it, because anyone interested in building a gaming platform based on the just-released AMD architecture should race to set their sights on one. The new Crosshair IV Formula (C4F) has enough features to turn it into an overclocking endurance king, making the most of 890FX advantages.

As per usual with Republic of Gamers gear, the first thing to grab you about the C4F is the nice design, using the trademark black and red color scheme and cool crystal-shaped heatsinks. This is just prelude, though, because we immediately turn to notice all the stuff that's packed onto the board. It's a cornucopia of assets making it a great choice for both seasoned tuners and those taking their first steps in the field of overclocking.

For one, C4F comes with ROG Connect, a hardware/software utility that opens up a very comprehensive overclocking interface capable of many settings and variables. The neat part about this one is remote overclocking by USB. Basically, users can mod their motherboard from a notebook, so the performance rig benchmarks while being tweaked. Less valuable resources are consumed, so scores go higher. ROG Connect doubles as a monitoring program, keeping tabs on the effects changes have on a setup and offering detailed stats.

Alongside ROG Connect lies Turbo Key II, an auto-tuning engine that's ideal for people still leaning about overclocking. It essentially runs through a series of tests, driving the hardware to its limits until it finds an optimal performance range. Everything's presented clearly on-screen, helping the uninitiated get an inside

look at how overclocking fundamentals work. Both of these can be activated either from the OS or through pressing a single button on the board itself, in case your monster rig is still under construction.

The convenience of this is pretty significant, as is the wonder of ASUS' exclusive Core Unlocker technology. As the name suggests, it opens up deactivated cores on AMD CPUs, so if a user gets a dual-core to save costs, they may be able to go up to a quad, or at least manage an additional core. No prizes for guessing there's a Core Unlocker button on the board, so the whole process only takes minutes. While results may vary, they inevitably lead to more processing muscle, and therefore a higher overclocking threshold.

As you can see, Crosshair IV Formula has a thing for indulging PC users with features, most tailored for speed. That's why we like GameFirst, another innovation from ASUS, this one managing on-board networking to maximize bandwidth when online. The main benefit is faster multiplayer gaming, with less lag and lower latency. Users can manually prioritize bandwidth, so even while in the thick of the action, other stuff can still work in the background with no slow down.

And all this before we even mention USB 3.0, six SATA 6GB/s connectors and the excellent SupremeFX X-Fi EAX 4.0 surround sound chip.

For gamers, this board is a complete package and ready to go. Beyond that, it's also a master overclocker, so we see great value in the C4F and recommend it you check it out pronto.



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